Grade 4 | Art

Student reading and activity booklet

36 introductory chapters aligned to the school year. Week 1 is an optional introduction; the updated schedule begins in Week 2 on October 19, 2026. Every numbered chapter occupies one PDF page, so Chapter N starts on PDF page N + 1.

Use Monday/Wednesday for Art and Life Sciences; Tuesday/Thursday for Computer Science and Life Skills. Read and model in the first session; apply, revise, and demonstrate in the second. Adapt the pace to the child. This is an original introductory booklet and practical workbook, not a claim of a complete specialist textbook.

Grade 4: explain with concrete examples, labeled drawings, and a short paragraph. Grade 7: explain using precise vocabulary, two reasons or pieces of evidence, a counterexample or limitation, and a developed paragraph.

Use fictional situations and public information. Do not require disclosure of personal beliefs, health, sexual experience, addresses, passwords, or family finances. Adults supervise tools, heat, cleaning products, health discussions, and first-aid practice. Religion is studied descriptively, without devotional participation or grading belief.

Reference and extension sources

https://www.coreknowledge.org/download-free-curriculum/

Chapter 1 | Lines and observation

Module 1 | Week 1 | PDF page 2

Read and discuss

Lines suggest edges, direction, and movement. Artists choose what to emphasize rather than recording every detail. Observation compares marks with what is seen.

First session: guided practice

Draw a familiar object with contour lines and revise after observing again.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

What can line communicate?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 2 | Shape, form, and proportion

Module 1 | Week 2 | PDF page 3

Read and discuss

Shape is two-dimensional; form occupies or suggests three dimensions. Proportion compares parts with each other or a whole. Artists may use realistic or intentionally altered proportions.

First session: guided practice

Sketch a body-system or object diagram and compare two proportions using number or ratio skills.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

How do shape and form differ?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 3 | Color and contrast

Module 1 | Week 3 | PDF page 4

Read and discuss

Color relationships guide attention and mood. Contrast uses differences such as light/dark or warm/cool. Interpretation depends on context and varies among viewers.

First session: guided practice

Make a value or color scale and use contrast to emphasize one feature.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

What can contrast do?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 4 | Composition and revision

Module 1 | Week 4 | PDF page 5

Read and discuss

Composition arranges elements within a work. Balance, emphasis, and negative space affect interpretation. Revision tests purposeful changes.

First session: guided practice

Create two small layouts about a social-studies topic and justify a revision.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

What is negative space?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 5 | Pattern and symmetry

Module 2 | Week 1 | PDF page 6

Read and discuss

Patterns repeat according to a rule. Symmetry relates parts through a transformation such as reflection. Repetition can be varied for interest.

First session: guided practice

Design a motif with a stated repetition rule and compare symmetrical/asymmetrical versions.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Must every pattern be symmetrical?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 6 | Texture and materials

Module 2 | Week 2 | PDF page 7

Read and discuss

Texture is surface quality, felt or visually suggested. Materials affect appearance and construction. Use clean safe parent-approved surfaces and tools.

First session: guided practice

Make safe texture rubbings and combine contrasting textures.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

How can a flat image suggest texture?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 7 | Space and perspective

Module 2 | Week 3 | PDF page 8

Read and discuss

Overlap, scale, position, and perspective can suggest depth. These strategies are not fixed rules for all traditions. Maps and perspective drawings serve different purposes.

First session: guided practice

Draw overlapping objects and compare the result with an overhead plan.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Why do maps and perspective drawings differ?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 8 | Design and communication

Module 2 | Week 4 | PDF page 9

Read and discuss

Design solves a communication problem for an audience. A symbol or label must be understandable as well as attractive. Test the message with users.

First session: guided practice

Design a household sign, ask someone to explain it, and revise.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

How is clarity tested?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 9 | Beat and rhythm

Module 3 | Week 1 | PDF page 10

Read and discuss

Beat is a regular pulse; rhythm organizes durations around it. Rhythm can change while beat remains steady. Use clapping or gentle tapping.

First session: guided practice

Tap a pulse, clap a pattern, and represent durations with symbols or fractions.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Are beat and rhythm identical?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 10 | Pitch and melody

Module 3 | Week 2 | PDF page 11

Read and discuss

Pitch concerns how high or low a sound is perceived. Melody arranges pitches over time. Voices and instruments have different ranges and qualities.

First session: guided practice

Trace a melody's rising/falling shape, then create a short humming pattern.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

What is melodic contour?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 11 | Dynamics and timbre

Module 3 | Week 3 | PDF page 12

Read and discuss

Dynamics concern relative loudness; timbre is sound quality. Changing either can alter an interpretation. Protect hearing and avoid unnecessarily loud sound.

First session: guided practice

Perform the same gentle rhythm with two sound qualities and dynamics.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

How do timbre and dynamics differ?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 12 | Musical form

Module 3 | Week 4 | PDF page 13

Read and discuss

Form organizes musical sections. ABA returns to an initial section after a contrasting one. Repetition and contrast help listeners follow a piece.

First session: guided practice

Create and perform A, contrasting B, and returning A sections.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

What returns in ABA?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 13 | Notation and duration

Module 4 | Week 1 | PDF page 14

Read and discuss

Notation records selected musical features. Values depend on the stated system and context. Count durations rather than assuming all symbols last the same time.

First session: guided practice

Notate a four-beat pattern and translate durations into a fraction model.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Why state the notation system?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 14 | Harmony and accompaniment

Module 4 | Week 2 | PDF page 15

Read and discuss

Accompaniment supports a main line; harmony concerns relationships among pitches heard or implied together. A supporting pattern need not duplicate the melody.

First session: guided practice

Create a gentle repeated accompaniment and combine it with a melody or spoken text.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Must accompaniment copy the melody?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 15 | Music and cultural context

Module 4 | Week 3 | PDF page 16

Read and discuss

Music serves purposes including celebration, worship, storytelling, and protest. Describe a named tradition with reliable context instead of treating a continent as one style.

First session: guided practice

Study one named musical example and compare its context respectfully with another.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Why identify a specific tradition?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 16 | Compose and perform

Module 4 | Week 4 | PDF page 17

Read and discuss

Composition selects sounds and structure; performance interprets those choices. Explain how a musical choice contributes to an intended effect.

First session: guided practice

Create a short sound piece about a science/history topic and revise after feedback.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

What supports an interpretation?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 17 | Art as historical evidence

Module 5 | Week 1 | PDF page 18

Read and discuss

Artwork can provide evidence about a place and time but does not represent everyone. Ask who made it, for whom, and why. Distinguish observation from historical inference.

First session: guided practice

Describe a selected artwork, research its context, and identify limits.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Can one artwork represent an entire society?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 18 | Architecture and geometry

Module 5 | Week 2 | PDF page 19

Read and discuss

Architecture combines function, materials, structure, and appearance. Drawings and models simplify buildings. Geometry and measurement communicate design choices.

First session: guided practice

Sketch a building with geometric shapes, then create a safe dimensioned paper model.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Why model before construction?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 19 | Symbols and meanings

Module 5 | Week 3 | PDF page 20

Read and discuss

Symbols gain meanings through context and use; meanings are not universal. Avoid copying sacred or culturally restricted designs without understanding the context.

First session: guided practice

Compare public symbols from reliable sources and create an original symbol.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Are symbols universal?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 20 | Comparing art traditions

Module 5 | Week 4 | PDF page 21

Read and discuss

Comparison identifies shared features and differences without ranking cultures by one preferred style. Support interpretations with visible details and accurate context.

First session: guided practice

Compare two specific works and write an evidence-based explanation.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

What makes a comparison well supported?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 21 | Theatre and character

Module 6 | Week 1 | PDF page 22

Read and discuss

Actions, speech, and goals shape a scene. Performance interprets rather than simply recites text. Different choices may support different reasonable interpretations.

First session: guided practice

Perform a short current-literature scene with two intentions and compare effects.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

How can performance change interpretation?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 22 | Voice and movement

Module 6 | Week 2 | PDF page 23

Read and discuss

Performers communicate with voice, gesture, posture, and timing. Adapt movement safely to different bodies. Clarity does not require shouting or strenuous action.

First session: guided practice

Perform a neutral sentence with different gestures or pacing and revise for an audience.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Must effective performance be loud?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 23 | Dance and sequences

Module 6 | Week 3 | PDF page 24

Read and discuss

Dance organizes movement through space and time. Sequences repeat, reverse, or vary like patterns. Respect named traditions and use safe original adapted movement.

First session: guided practice

Design and repeat an original movement sequence under a stated pattern.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

How can dance resemble an algorithm?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 24 | Stagecraft and collaboration

Module 6 | Week 4 | PDF page 25

Read and discuss

Performances combine writing, acting, design, and coordination. Planned responsibilities and transitions help audiences follow. Use safe simple props.

First session: guided practice

Create a miniature production plan and present a short scene.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Why assign production roles?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 25 | Photography and framing

Module 7 | Week 1 | PDF page 26

Read and discuss

Framing selects part of a scene; photographs can be accurate but incomplete. Ask permission before photographing people or private spaces.

First session: guided practice

Frame the same harmless object two ways, or draw the two views; identify omissions.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Does a photo show everything about an event?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 26 | Storyboards and narrative

Module 7 | Week 2 | PDF page 27

Read and discuss

Storyboards arrange images to plan a narrative or explanation. Viewpoint and timing affect meaning. Captions clarify each panel's purpose.

First session: guided practice

Storyboard a scientific process or literature scene and test the sequence with a partner.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

What is a storyboard for?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 27 | Digital art and layers

Module 7 | Week 3 | PDF page 28

Read and discuss

Digital images can be built in parts. Layers separate elements for easier editing and arrangement. Credit reused assets and keep private information out of images.

First session: guided practice

Plan a layered image on paper or digitally and revise one element.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Why use layers?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 28 | Critique and feedback

Module 7 | Week 4 | PDF page 29

Read and discuss

Critique describes, analyzes, interprets, and evaluates using reasons. Useful feedback is specific and connected to the artist's goal. Disagreement can remain respectful.

First session: guided practice

Give specific feedback and revise your own work with an explanation.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

What makes feedback actionable?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 29 | Sculpture and balance

Module 8 | Week 1 | PDF page 30

Read and discuss

Sculpture occupies space and has multiple viewpoints. Balance involves appearance and physical stability. Use lightweight safe materials.

First session: guided practice

Build a paper/recycled form, test stability, and revise.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

How does sculpture differ from flat drawing?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 30 | Craft and function

Module 8 | Week 2 | PDF page 31

Read and discuss

Craft combines function and appearance. Materials and use constrain designs. Decoration alone does not guarantee that something is strong or useful.

First session: guided practice

Design a measured paper container and evaluate appearance and function separately.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Why evaluate function?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 31 | Public art and audience

Module 8 | Week 3 | PDF page 32

Read and discuss

Public art addresses varied audiences. Location affects meaning, access, and impact. Consider the people affected by a proposed work.

First session: guided practice

Sketch a fictional community art proposal and explain audience/access choices.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Why consider location?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 32 | Exhibitions and curation

Module 8 | Week 4 | PDF page 33

Read and discuss

Curation selects and arranges works to communicate ideas. Labels explain context and attribution. Selection itself creates an interpretation.

First session: guided practice

Select three works around a theme, order them, and write labels.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

What does a curator do?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 33 | Capstone planning

Module 9 | Week 1 | PDF page 34

Read and discuss

Art plans state purpose, audience, medium, materials, and constraints. Planning makes creative choices visible. Include safe materials and realistic time.

First session: guided practice

Plan a work connecting the week's mathematics, science, or social studies and test a draft.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

What belongs in a plan?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 34 | Create and document

Module 9 | Week 2 | PDF page 35

Read and discuss

Process records reveal choices and experiments that finished work may hide. Record unsuccessful changes honestly as well as successful ones.

First session: guided practice

Create a draft and document two choices, then revise one feature.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Why document making?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 35 | Refine and explain

Module 9 | Week 3 | PDF page 36

Read and discuss

Refinement uses feedback and evaluation. Artist statements explain choices without requiring every viewer to feel the same. Support claims with observable features.

First session: guided practice

Revise a capstone work and write an evidence-based artist statement.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

Must all viewers interpret identically?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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Chapter 36 | Present and reflect

Module 9 | Week 4 | PDF page 37

Read and discuss

Presentation provides context and clear explanation. Reflection identifies growth, limits, and goals. Credit collaborators and borrowed material.

First session: guided practice

Present selected work or adapted performance with a strength, limitation, and next step.

Second session: apply and revise

Use a concrete example and labeled drawing; explain your result in 3-5 sentences. Review the first attempt with your parent and improve one specific feature.

Check your understanding

What belongs in thoughtful reflection?

My answer: _____

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Activity record: sketch, steps, measurements, or observations

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One revision and why it helps: _____

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